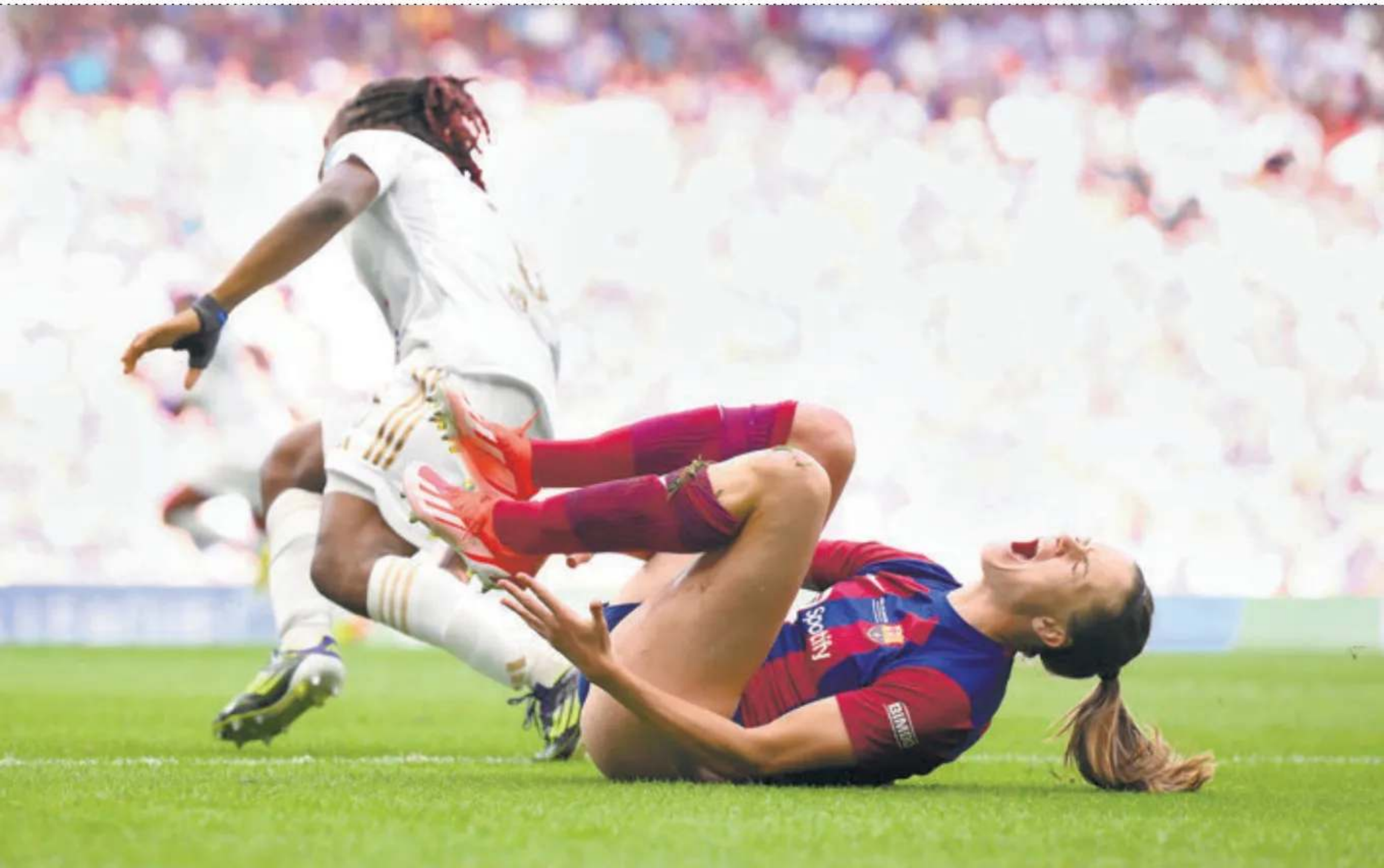




collaboration between researchers, support staff, and clinicians, as well as understanding that efficacy does not equate to effectiveness. To find an ideal pattern in training to performance domain, large amounts of data need to be collated over time, considering many variables from sport to sport, skill to skill, and individual to individual. The effectiveness of training modes can be derived through the correct inference of the data collected.

From an Indian perspective related to data collection and load management principles, we need to develop our own system with a foolproof process tailored to our athletes. Borrowing old data from other countries proves futile in the long run and detrimental to our sports science ecosystem. This hard and laborious process is necessary if we want to compete with the best. With the dedication and passion of the younger generation, future performance for India can improve, or else we will continue to face

enquiry commissions for our poor performance as we always have.

Change can come from the younger generation passionate about sports science. Many self-proclaimed experts on social media seek financial security and brand building by currying favour with selected players. These professionals can be dangerous for trusting sports persons. Proper due diligence is needed before involving them in mainstream sports science. Ultimately, what matters is creating history for India, rather than economics for individuals.

Changing times: Earlier, injuries were directly related to training intensity, load, incorrect methods, and exercise choices. Now, injuries can be attributed to sudden spikes in training load. GETTY IMAGES **Left:** Rishabh Pant had to undergo a gruelling 14-month rehab after his horrific accident. PTI



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